retain the status of being indigenous must necessarily subscribe to certain ahistorical and perhaps even unscientific approximations.

Also, if ethnicity or birth were to be accepted as the sole or primary metrics for indigeneity, it would fail to address those situations where ethnicity remains the same and the entire OET framework is altered owing to evangelisation. Therefore, a strictly birth-based or ethnocentric approach to indigeneity, which is a consequence of present-day rules for acquisition of citizenship being retrofitted to a much more complex construct, misses the entire point of indigeneity. Since contemporary laws of acquisition of nationality operate within a legal framework that is colonial, they cannot and must not be used to understand indigeneity that challenges the foundations of the system as it exists.

Finally, several decolonised societies, despite not having converted to the religion of the coloniser, have moved on from their precolonial pasts because they have embraced secularised coloniality, namely ‘modernity’. This means that those who retain their indigenous consciousness by subscribing to the indigenous way of life (‘indigeneity’) are dwindling in number while the indigenous ‘identity’ has become merely an external legal marker. Simply put, the former is a state or condition of the mind, while the latter is a legal status. Since one of the objects of decoloniality is to revive and preserve the former as a response to coloniality, the term indigeneity, that is, the state of being indigenous and retaining indigenous consciousness, is preferred to ‘indigenous peoples’.

At this juncture, it also needs to be pointed out that scholars, such as Mignolo, while recognising that re-emergence of indigeneity results in decolonial delinking of the Western imperialist’s control over lives all over the world, take the position that decoloniality ‘does not equal indigenous struggle’ and that it is ‘not an ethnic, national or religious identification project’.[34] In my opinion, the goal of decoloniality may be to limit the universalist claim of the modernity/rationality complex of coloniality; however, what must replace coloniality and what must be the priority of indigeneity should be determined not by scholars of decoloniality, but by decolonialised indigenous societies, even if it takes the shape of an ethnic or religious identification project based on their respective histories.

What does this translate to in practical application? In the context of Latin America, scholars of decoloniality take the position that indigeneity is defined as the state of indigenous societies as they existed prior to 1492,